

Workineh Asmare Kassie

Contact Information	School of Economics, University of Gondar	✉ workiteth@gmail.com workineh.asmare@uog.edu.et ☎ +251-913-594977
Professional Summary	Development economist with experience designing and executing rigorous impact evaluation projects in Ethiopia. Good track record of managing complex data pipelines, coordinating research teams, and translating technical evidence into actionable policy insights for government and implementation partners. Skilled in problem-solving, cross functional communication, and adapting quickly to evolving needs from industry, government and funding partners. Good command of statistical tools to combine administrative, satellite, and survey data for geospatial analysis, and survey platforms for project operations (surveyCTO).	
Employment	University of Gondar (UoG) , Gondar, Ethiopia	
	<i>Director, Center for Policy and Strategy studies</i>	2025 – 2026
	• Led the planning, organization, and staffing of the center. • Oversaw the execution of multiple initiatives & projects. • Collaborated with senior academic & policy makers, mentored graduate students. • Introduced standardized protocols for coding, reproducibility, and data quality.	
	<i>Assistant Professor, School of Economics</i>	2024 – 2026
	• Taught development economics to graduate students. • Established & managed the operation of a development research & training lab. • Developed project ideas, created research groups, wrote several grant proposals and attracted research grants.	
	<i>Lecturer / Graduate Assistant</i>	2014 – 2019 / 2007 – 2009
	• Chaired School of Economics (2017-2018) . • Taught undergraduate courses, mentor graduate essay writing.	
	Policy Studies Institute (PSI) , Addis Ababa, Ethiopia	
	<i>Research Associate, ACC Program Evaluation</i>	2024 – 2025
	• Led the study of the ACC program, coordinating between line ministries, ESSGSI, ATI, ESS, and researchers to ensure policy relevance. • Managed the construction of a comprehensive spatial panel dataset (2016–2024), combining administrative records, geospatial, and program implementation data for a rigorous Difference-in-Differences (DiD) and Event Study analysis. • Present impact evidence to the research and policy community.	
Education	Southwestern University of Finance and Economics, China	
	PhD in Economics	2024
	Ruhr University Bochum, Germany	
	MA in Development Management	2016
	Addis Ababa University, Ethiopia	
	MSc in Applied Economics (Policy Analysis)	2014
	University of Gondar, Ethiopia	
	BA in Economics	2007

Research Grants	“Unintended Effect of Education Expansion Policy: Evidence of Impact on Conflict in Ethiopia”, CEPR, ReCIPE Compact Research Grant, PI. 2026 – 2027
	“Cluster Farming and Firms: Impact on Agro-Processing Firms in Ethiopia”, Policy Studies Institute (PSI), Policy Research, Lead. 2024 – 2025
	“Integration of women IDPs with the host community to enhance their livelihood”, IPA, Displace Livelihoods Initiative (DLI), Exploratory, Co-PI. 2024 – 2025
	“Catalyzing Structural Transformation: Evidence from Ethiopia’s ACC Initiative”, CEPR, STEG Small Grant, Co-PI. 2024 – 2025
	“Empowering Displaced Children through Innovative Education Interventions”, JPAL, Learning for All Initiative (LAI), Exploratory, Co-PI. 2023 – 2024
	“Impact of small-scale irrigation on rural women’s empowerment and nutrition outcomes: Evidence from Ethiopia”, ICED, IINDWEGE, Co-PI. 2022 – 2023
	“Impact of Farmers Training Centers on the adoption of CGIAR innovations: Evidence from Ethiopia”, SPIA, Small PhD Grant, PI. 2021 – 2022
	“Distributional impacts of large-scale land transactions: Evidence from Ethiopia”, ICED, ALL-IN Program, Co-PI. 2021 – 2023
	“Heterogeneous impact of large-scale land transaction in Ethiopia”, USAID Feed the Future Program, Exploratory, Co-PI. 2019
	“Agricultural technology adoption and rural poverty: Evidence from Ethiopia”, IGC and EEA, Young Researchers Grant, Co-PI. 2015 – 2016
Peer-Reviewed Publications	“Study of smallholders’ economic choices, aspirations and innovation”, University of Gondar, Faculty Thematic Research Grant, PI. 2015 – 2016
	“Large-scale land acquisitions in Ethiopia: The effect on agriculture productivity and deforestation”, <i>with</i> Admasu Yeshwas, Belay Dagim, Waleign Solomon & Jipeng Zhang. <i>Journal of Development Economics</i> , forthcoming, 2026
	“The impact of large-scale land transactions on welfare and livelihoods of local communities: Meta-analysis”, <i>with</i> Akalu Lingreh, Wang Huashu & Waleign, Solomon. <i>Humanities and Social Sciences Communications</i> 12, no.1, 1-15, 2025
	“The effect of agricultural information provision on smallholders’ technology adoption and yield”, <i>with</i> Waje Samuel, Shano Bekele & Waleign Solomon <i>Frontiers in Sustainable Food Systems</i> , 8, 2024.
	“Pro-environmental behavior under bundled environmental and poverty reduction goals”, <i>with</i> Kahsay Goytom, Hansen Lars, & Beyene Abebe. <i>Land Policy</i> , 112. 2022.
	“Are religious farmers more risk taking?”, <i>with</i> Kahsay Goytom & Hansen Lars. <i>Agricultural Economics</i> , 53(4). 2022.
Work in progress	“Agricultural technology adoption and rural poverty”, <i>with</i> Kebede Samuel & Mekonnen Tessema. <i>Ethiopian Journal of Economics</i> , 23(2). 2015.
	“Small-scale irrigation schemes and farm productivity: Evidence from an irrigation and drainage project”, <i>with</i> Admasu Yeshwas, Tadesse Melkamu, Waleign Solomon, & Akalu Sewnet. <i>Manuscript</i>
	“Dysfunctional training centers: Impact of agricultural research and extension reform on rural incomes and technology adoption”, <i>with</i> Admasu Yeshwas, Waleign Solomon, Ayalew Hailemariam, & Jipeng Zhang. <i>Manuscript</i>
	“Individual religiosity, risk preference and farmer’s investment in resilience enhancing technologies”, <i>with</i> Kahsay Goytom, & Jipeng Zhang. <i>Manuscript</i>

“Agricultural Commercialization and Structural Change: Evidence from Ethiopia”, *with* Admasu Yeshwas & Walelign Solomon. *Research report*

“Impact of small-scale irrigation on women empowerment and nutrition outcomes: Evidence from Ethiopia”, *with* Admasu Yeshwas, Tadesse Melkamu, Akalu Lingerh, Getahun Wondwesen, & Walelign Solomon. *Research report*

“The welfare impacts of Large-Scale Land Transactions: Evidence from Ethiopia”, *with* Walelign Solomon, Admasu Yeshwas, Jededia Siliver, Belay Dagim, & Tadesse Melkamu. *Data analysis*

“Cluster Farming and Firms: Impact on Agro-Processing Firms in Ethiopia ”, *with* Walelign Solomon, Admasu Yeshwas, Ejigu Habtamu, Woldekidan Hana, Tilahun Solomon, & Girma Tewolde. *Data analysis*

“Exporting as a buffer: Firm’s resilience to internal conflict”, *with* Ejigu Habtamu & Kassa Wubet. *Data analysis*

“Unintended consequences of policy reforms on conflict: Evidence from Education Policy in Ethiopia”, *with* Admasu Yeshwas, & Ayalew Hailemariam. *Early stage*

Selected
Presentations

“Ethiopian PSNP and pro-environmental behavior: Some evidence of crowding out”, *CAAS Conference, 2018. Queen’s Univeersity, Canada*

“Impact of farmer training centers on the adoption of agricultural technologies in Ethiopia”, *ICED E2A Conference, 2022. Makerere University, Uganda*

“Incentive designs and crowding-out of pro-environmental behavior among Ethiopian farmers”, *WCERE Conference, 2018. Gutenberg University, Sweden*

“Risk preference and discounting behavior of smallholders: Evidence from field experiment”, *Graduate Workshop, 2019. RIEM, China*

“The effect of individual risk preference on livelihood diversification: Evidence from a field experiment”, *Int. Conference on the Ethiopian Economy, 2018. EEA, Ethiopia*

References

It will be provided upon request.